

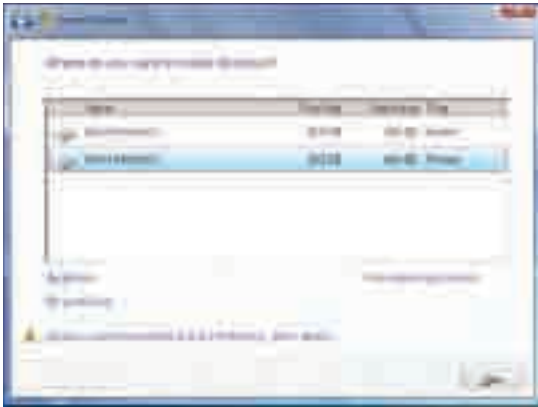
Mobile in space

British scientists are planning to launch a mobile into orbit to test the device's vulnerability

iPhone 4 on Verizon

The much awaited move of the iPhone 4 will finally happen on February 10

Workshop



Enter the location for the setup of Windows

Windows 7 setup by typing setup at the command prompt. You will notice, at the hard drive selection step, that the newly created VHD will now be available as an option. Select that drive and then run the Windows setup as normal!

Your computer will not be able to boot to this Windows version just yet, but we will come to that later.

Option 2: Use a script to generate a Windows 7 VHD from the setup disk

For this you will need the following:

1. Windows 7 setup disk (Ultimate)
 2. Windows 7 Automated Installation Kit (AIK) 2.0
 3. The Win2VHD Script
- (2) and (3) are available on the DVD.

The procedure for generating the VHD from the Windows 7 DVD is simple:

1. First of all install the Windows 7 Automated Installation Kit (AIK) 2.0 after either mounting the iso file or burning it.
2. Now copy the Win2VHD script (win2vhd.wsf) file from the Digit DVD to a convenient location..
3. Insert the Windows 7 setup disk into your disk drive.
4. Using the command line, enter the folder in which you copied the script and the imagex.exe file, and run the following command line:
`cscript win2vhd.wsf /wim:X:\sources\install.wim /`

sku:ultimate

Here X: is the drive letter for your Windows 7 disc.

This step will take quite some time, depending on your hard-drive and CD drive speed and the speed of your computer, 15 minutes is not out of the ordinary. Once it is done, you will find a new .vhd file created in the same folder where you ran the script – it should be around 6GB. This is a fresh bootable Windows installation inside a vhd file!

The wim2vhd script only makes it simpler to create a VHD file from the “install.wim” file by automating the creation and partitioning of a VHD using diskpart, and subsequently using imagex from the AIK to copy contents from the install.wim file to the vhd file. You can do this yourself, but the script makes it much simpler. In case wim2vhd can't locate imagex.exe, copy it to the same directory as the script (it can be found at C:\Program Files\Windows AIK\Tools or similar).

You can even specify the path to the vhd file in the command line if you so desire. You can learn a bit more about the options you have by running “cscript wim2vhd.wsf” without any arguments.

Bootting from the VHD

This part is considerably simpler. All you need to do is install EasyBCD 2.0 and it will expose an option to boot from a VHD file. EasyBCD



Boot directly into a virtual hard disk

is available on the Digit DVD.

The “Add New Entry” tool has a tab called “Virtual Disk” in the lower half that can be used for this purpose. Once you have selected your vhd file, given it a name, and added the entry, you will be able to boot to it using the command line.

Advantages of using a VHD

Some of these advantages are over using a virtualised OS, and others are over a normal native install, since this lies somewhere in between:

- Your entire OS is inside a single file
With your OS in a single file it is easy to copy in case you get a new hard drive or want a copy of the same OS.
- You can use a differencing disk to keep your base system clean while keeping changes separate
With differencing disks, you can install Windows to your base HDD and capture any changes over that (software / driver installs etc.) in a different drive. This way you can have multiple configs, while saving a little space with just a single base install.
- You can make snapshots of your disk with greater ease and revert in case of viruses
Differencing can help even more here. You can create one base VHD image with a Windows 7 install, another hard drive based on this one in which you install all your apps. And a third further hard drive based on the second that has beta applications etc installed. You can use multiple differencing disks and be able to boot into multiple different software configurations using the same base OS.
- Only the hard drive is virtualised, so you get better performance
Microsoft claims that there will only be about a 3% loss in performance due to this mode of installation. Apps that are not hard disk heavy can have less of a drop in performance.
- You have direct access to native hardware. You can use it for gaming, since you have direct access to the graphics card. Virtual machines cannot handle 3D graphical application that well yet. Convinced yet? 